

Past Grant Application 5: Soapy Bore Water Resilience & Filtration

1. Application Overview

- **Applicant:** Urapuntja Health Service Aboriginal Corporation (UHSAC)
 - **ABN:** 45 449 518 275
 - **Funder:** Northern Territory Government / Department of Territory Families, Housing and Communities
 - **Funding Program:** Remote Communities Infrastructure Fund (RCIF) (Round 3)
 - **Amount Requested:** \$250,000.00
 - **Status:** Successfully Awarded (Completed and Acquitted June 2025)
 - **Key Contact:** Ms. Melissa Hinson (CEO UHSAC) / Marcus Deluis (Infrastructure Coordinator)
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2. Project Proposal

2.1 Project Title

Soapy Bore Primary Health Clinic Water Quality and Filtration Upgrade

2.2 Project Summary

The primary health clinic at Amengernterne (Soapy Bore) relies on local underground bore water. High mineral content (calcium carbonate, silica) and intermittent microbiological contamination pose a severe health risk to staff, vulnerable renal patients, and expectant mothers. This project requests \$250,000 to purchase and install a commercial-grade, solar-powered reverse osmosis (RO) water filtration system, replace the aging 50,000-litre storage tanks, and implement a monthly chemical/microbiological water testing regime.

2.3 Objectives

1. Provide constant access to safe, WHO-compliant drinking water at the central clinic.
2. Reduce scale buildup in clinic medical equipment, extending operational life.
3. Install an off-grid solar-battery unit to run the RO system during mains power outages.

4. Train local maintenance staff in basic filter cleaning and routine testing.

2.4 Project Deliverables

- Solar-powered commercial Reverse Osmosis system (capacity 5,000 L/day).
- 2x 25,000L heavy-duty polyethylene water storage tanks.
- 10kW ground-mounted solar array + 15kWh lithium battery storage.
- Certified water quality test reports confirming removal of impurities.

3. Project Budget

Expense Category	Detailed Description	Cost (AUD)
Filtration Equipment	Industrial RO unit + filter membranes + replacement cartridges	\$65,000
Storage Tanks	2x 25,000L poly tanks, concrete pads, and connection pipework	\$35,000
Solar Power Unit	10kW solar panels, inverter, battery system, security fencing	\$75,000
Installation Labour	Specialised plumbing and electrical contractors travel & onsite	\$55,000
Testing & Training	Local staff certification, commissioning, water laboratory audit	\$10,000
Project Contingency	Buffer for remote shipping and freight cost overruns	\$10,000
Total Project Cost		\$250,000